

ANCIENT ORDER OF FREE GARDENERS, INC.

SOCIAL MEDIA & MARKETING POLICY

For Lodges & Members

All official Lodge pages, promotional materials, merchandise, photographs, and public communications represent the **Ancient Order of Free Gardeners, Inc. (AOFG Inc.)** and must reflect the identity, standards, and traditions of our organization.

For detailed requirements concerning logos, colors, symbols, typography, and visual presentation, always refer to the **AOFG Inc. Branding Guide**.

OUR STANDARD

AOFG Inc. pages should look like us, sound like us, and tell our story.

Free Gardening includes a number of organizations and traditions around the world. While we respect those organizations and their histories, AOFG Inc. Lodges must maintain a clear and distinct identity to prevent public confusion and to respect the unique branding, symbols, regalia, and traditions of other Free Gardener organizations.

LODGES AND MEMBERS SHALL:

- Use approved **AOFG Inc. logos, colors, symbols, terminology, and regalia** when representing the Order.
- Follow the current **AOFG Inc. Branding Guide** when creating flyers, social-media graphics, websites, merchandise, advertisements, and other promotional materials.
- Clearly identify the Lodge by its proper name and number on official accounts.
- Prioritize original content showing **AOFG Inc. members, events, service, fellowship, education, and traditions**.
- Obtain permission when required before reposting photographs, artwork, graphics, written material, or videos created by others.
- Credit the original source when appropriate.
- Protect the privacy of members, guests, candidates, and the public.
- Check photographs carefully for private, ritual, membership, financial, or confidential information before posting.
- Discuss other Free Gardener organizations respectfully and accurately.
- Correct or remove inaccurate, unauthorized, or improperly branded content promptly.

LODGES AND MEMBERS SHALL NOT:

- Use another Free Gardener organization's logo, seal, badge, regalia, symbols, or unique artwork as though it belongs to AOFG Inc.

- Assume that every symbol described online as “Free Gardener” is used by our branch of the tradition.
- Download another organization’s graphic and replace its logo with an AOFG Inc. logo.
- Remove watermarks, credits, logos, or identifying marks from another organization’s material.
- Create graphics that blend AOFG Inc. branding with the branding of another Free Gardener organization in a way that suggests affiliation.
- Routinely repost material from other Free Gardener organizations on official Lodge pages.
- Wear merchandise or regalia bearing symbols specific to another Free Gardener organization when formally representing AOFG Inc. in promotional photographs, videos, public events, or official functions.
- Use official Lodge pages to routinely promote Freemasonry, Odd Fellows, Elks, Greek-letter organizations, or other unrelated fraternal orders.
- Use official Lodge accounts for personal political opinions, disputes, businesses, grievances, or unrelated causes.
- Publish private ritual, recognition, membership, financial, or internal organizational information.
- Claim to speak officially for AOFG Inc. without proper authority.

SHARING CONTENT FROM OTHER FREE GARDENER ORGANIZATIONS

Content from another Free Gardener organization may be shared when there is a legitimate reason, including:

- historical education;
- authorized joint events;
- fraternal visits;
- congratulations or condolences;
- scholarly discussion; or
- recognition of another organization.

Whenever such content is posted, the originating organization must be **clearly identified**.

When possible, use the social-media platform’s native **share or repost feature** instead of downloading and republishing another organization’s material.

Never present another organization’s symbols, regalia, ceremonies, or customs as AOFG Inc. practices.

OTHER FRATERNAL ORGANIZATIONS

Official AOFG Inc. Lodge pages exist to promote **Free Gardening and AOFG Inc.**

Material relating to other fraternal organizations should only appear when directly relevant to an approved joint activity, historical discussion, community partnership, or other legitimate AOFG Inc. purpose.

Personal membership in another fraternity does not make that organization's content appropriate for an AOFG Inc. Lodge page.

REGALIA & MERCHANDISE

When publicly representing AOFG Inc., members should wear:

- authorized AOFG Inc. regalia;
- AOFG Inc. apparel;
- Lodge-approved attire; or
- appropriate neutral clothing.

Items bearing symbols specific to another Free Gardener organization should not be presented as AOFG Inc. merchandise, insignia, or regalia.

BEFORE YOU POST — ASK:

Is it relevant?

Is it accurate?

Is it AOFG Inc. branding?

Is the symbol actually ours?

Do we have permission to use it?

Could it confuse the public about another organization?

Does it reveal anything private or confidential?

Would we be comfortable seeing it shared outside our intended audience?

If there is uncertainty, **do not post until clarification is obtained.**

REMEMBER

Maintaining a distinct AOFG Inc. identity does not diminish other Free Gardener traditions. It demonstrates respect for them.

Use AOFG Inc. symbols.

Use AOFG Inc. regalia.

Use AOFG Inc. branding.

Tell AOFG Inc. stories.

When in doubt, consult the AOFG Inc. Branding Guide.